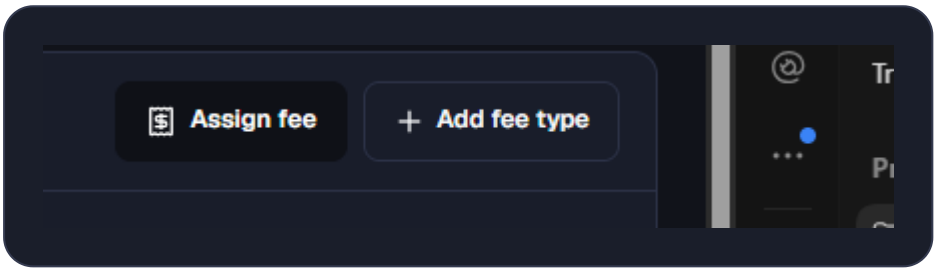
PRODUCT & OPERATIONS REVIEW

Making tuition setup Philippine-school ready

A supervisor-ready review of the **Assign fee** and **Add fee type** workflows in XMETA Pay.



CURRENT STATE

A strong MVP for one flat charge

Reusable fee setup, bulk student selection, authorization, transaction safety, and duplicate prevention are already present.

RECOMMENDED DIRECTION

Build a complete assessment workflow

Add approved fee schedules, credits, reusable payment plans, preview, posting control, and a transparent parent statement.

Prepared for supervisor discussion
Product, finance operations, and implementation planning

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The decision in one page

The two buttons correctly separate reusable fee setup from student posting. The backend also applies strong authorization, school-year scoping, enrollment validation, transactions, and duplicate protection. The operational model, however, is still designed around a single flat charge rather than the full assessment cycle used by Philippine private schools.

Keep

Role protection, active-school-year scope, bulk grade/section selection, transaction safety, and duplicate skipping.

Change first

Correct installment dates, require a tuition deadline or plan, and stop using a custom amount as a substitute for discounts.

Build next

Approved fee schedules by grade/track, reusable payment plans, vouchers and discounts as separate credits, and a batch preview.

Target outcome

A Statement of Account showing gross charges, credits, net payable, installment dates, payments, and balance.

RECOMMENDED PRODUCT LANGUAGE

Current	Recommended	Why
Add fee type	**Manage fee catalog**	Signals setup, applicability, approval, and lifecycle management.
Assign fee	**Create student assessments**	Matches school finance language and makes the posting consequence clearer.
Assign fee (submit)	**Review assessments**	Adds a safety checkpoint before bulk posting.
Final confirmation	**Post 128 assessments**	Shows exactly what will happen and reduces accidental posting.

Decision requested

Approve a two-stage improvement: first fix correctness and posting safety; then expand into a Philippine-ready assessment workflow. Separate charges, credits, and schedules before adding more fields to the current modal.

CURRENT WORKFLOW

How the two buttons work today

1. **Create type**
   Name + default amount
2. **Choose fee**
   Active school year
3. **Select students**
   Grade, section, search
4. **Post charge**
   Optional amount + date

Area	Add fee type	Assign fee
Purpose	Create a reusable charge definition.	Post one selected charge to enrolled students.
Inputs	Fee name and default amount.	Fee type, students, optional custom amount, optional overall due date.
Scope	Active school year and category: tuition or other fee.	Active school, school year, category, and currently enrolled students.
Protection	Duplicate name protection.	Authorization, enrollment validation, transaction, and duplicate skipping.
After saving	Immediately active and selectable.	Balances become visible in admin and parent fee screens.
Missing	Applicability, approval, versioning, edit/archive, and payment plan.	Preview, separate credits, plan selection, audit batch, and preserved errors.

Important dependency

A fee type must exist before an assessment can be created. Today, the primary dark button is Assign fee. When the catalog is empty, the user discovers the prerequisite only after opening the modal.

Backend strengths

Admin/finance role checks, school and year ownership, current enrollment validation, one database transaction, and duplicate-safe inserts.

Front-end strengths

Grade and section filters, student search, bulk selection, selected count, responsive form layout, and clear category separation.

PRIORITY FINDINGS

What must improve

Pri.	Finding	Operational effect	Recommended response
P0	**Installment dates are replaced by the overall deadline**	Every term can appear with the same date although individual dates are stored.	Use the actual term due date in parent fees, payment selection, reminders, exports, and ordering.
P0	**Tuition deadline is optional**	Terms cannot later be saved without an overall deadline.	Require either a full-payment deadline or a selected payment plan.
P0	**Custom amount hides gross-to-net**	A reduced amount erases tuition, subsidy source, approval, and reporting trail.	Model vouchers, scholarships, discounts, and adjustments as separate credits.
P1	**Plans are manual per student**	Finance rebuilds the same schedule for every student row.	Apply reusable full, semestral, quarterly, monthly, or down-payment plans in the batch.
P1	**No review before bulk posting**	Large batches can post without totals, exceptions, or duplicate preview.	Add a review step and explicit final confirmation.
P1	**Catalog is too generic**	Name and amount cannot describe grade, strand, term, status, or approval.	Introduce structured, versioned fee schedules.
P2	**Clear matching clears everything**	The label implies filtered removal but selections outside the filter are also cleared.	Remove only visible IDs and keep a separate Clear all action.
P2	**Feedback and accessibility gaps**	No pending state, inline server errors, focus trap, or form preservation after redirect.	Add pending feedback, inline errors, focus management, and draft preservation.

P0 = correctness or financial-record risk. P1 = major workflow and scale gap. P2 = usability and accessibility improvement.

PHILIPPINE-SCHOOL FIT

Move from one net charge to an itemized assessment

A practical student account should retain the original approved charge and show every subsidy or discount separately. This creates a reliable Statement of Account, supports audit and voucher reporting, and gives parents a transparent explanation of what they owe.



Layer	Examples	Recommended record
Gross charges	Tuition, miscellaneous, laboratory, activity, technology	Itemized fee lines from an approved schedule
Government support	ESC and SHS Voucher Program	Credit with program, beneficiary reference, amount, and school-year status
School assistance	Scholarship, sibling, employee, academic, early payment	Named credit with approval and reason
Adjustments	Waiver, correction, transfer, withdrawal	Audited debit or credit adjustment; never overwrite history
Net responsibility	Amount payable by parent or guardian	Calculated result, not a manually substituted charge

Public vs. private scope

Public basic-education fee rules differ substantially. Configure this assessment workflow explicitly for private-school operations rather than treating it as universal.

Academic-access safeguard

Do not use an ordinary unpaid-balance flag as an automatic exam-access block. Keep assistance certification and promissory-note workflows separate from collection status.

RECOMMENDED FUTURE FLOW

A safer assessment journey

1. **Fee schedule** — Approved catalog
2. **Population** — Grade / section
3. **Credits** — Voucher / discount
4. **Plan** — Full / installments
5. **Review** — Counts + totals
6. **Post batch** — Audit ID
7. **Statement** — Parent sees detail
8. **Collect** — Terms + payments
9. **Reconcile** — Receipts + reports

Step	User sees	System guarantees
1. Select schedule	Year, grade/track, itemized charges, approval status	Only active, approved schedules are postable
2. Select population	Filters, search, visible and hidden selection counts	Only eligible, currently enrolled students are included
3. Apply credits	Voucher, scholarship, discount, amount, reason, reference	Gross charges remain unchanged; net is calculated
4. Choose plan	Full, semestral, quarterly, monthly, approved custom	Terms equal net payable and use actual due dates
5. Review	New, duplicate, excluded, exceptional, total peso amounts	Nothing posts until confirmation
6. Post	Explicit action such as Post 128 assessments	One transaction, batch audit trail, actor, timestamp, correction path
7. Parent statement	Charges, credits, net, terms, payments, receipts, balance	Portal, reminders, exports, and reports use the same figures

PROPOSED SCREEN STRUCTURE

Make the next action obvious

Student assessments - School Year 2026-2027

Manage fee catalog | + Create assessments

Search students, assessments, or references... | Grade: All | Status: All

128	P5.12M	P3.71M	P1.41M
Students assessed	Gross charges	Net payable	Outstanding

Student	Gross / credits	Payment plan	Balance
Maria Santos Grade 11 - STEM	P40,000 -P11,000 credits	Quarterly Next: 15 Dec	**P29,000**
Juan Dela Cruz Grade 8 - Rizal	P32,000 -P9,000 ESC	Monthly Next: 05 Dec	**P23,000**

Design principle	How it improves the current screen
Primary action reflects the job	Create assessments is primary; catalog maintenance remains available but secondary.
Financial story is visible	Gross, credits, net, plan, next due, and balance appear without multiple dialogs.
Batch work remains safe	The wizard previews affected students, exceptions, duplicates, and totals before posting.
Mobile remains practical	Actions stack below 420 px, targets are at least 44 px, and dense tables adapt to cards or detail views.
Accessibility is completion	Focus trap and restoration, visible focus, labels, status announcements, and no hover-only actions.
Local financial formatting	Use the Philippine peso symbol and en-PH formatting consistently across UI, statements, exports, and receipts.

DELIVERY ROADMAP

Stage the work around risk

Phase	Scope	Exit condition
1 - Correctness	Actual term dates; required deadline or plan; fix Clear matching; pending states, inline errors, batch review.	Portal, payments, reminders, and exports agree on every amount and date.
2 - Fee catalog	Applicability, fee codes, itemized schedules, approval states, edit/archive, and history.	Only approved schedules are assessed; prior years remain intact.
3 - Credits	ESC, SHS voucher, scholarships, discounts, and adjustments as separate ledger entries.	Gross, credits, net, and funding source reconcile by student and batch.
4 - Plans	Reusable full, semestral, quarterly, monthly, down-payment, and exception schedules.	A batch creates accurate terms without row-by-row repetition.
5 - Statements	Itemized SOA, receipts, audit reports, approval references, assistance and promissory-note workflows.	Parents, finance, and supervisors see the same auditable financial story.

SUCCESS MEASURES

Efficiency

Time to assess one grade, manual term edits, and batch rework rate.

Accuracy

Mismatched due dates, post-assessment adjustments, and reconciliation errors.

Parent clarity

Statement views, reminder-to-payment conversion, inquiries, and disputed balances.

Control

Assessments from approved schedules and credits with complete references and audit actor.

Suggested meeting close

Approve Phase 1 immediately, confirm the private K-12 target, and schedule a finance workshop to validate fee schedules, credit types, and real payment plans before Phase 2 design.

APPENDIX

Evidence and discussion prompts

Code evidence reviewed

Area	Observed implementation
Fee creation	app/admin/fees/fee-management-forms.tsx and app/admin/fees/actions.ts
Student selection	app/admin/fees/fee-student-checklist.tsx
Fee records / parent display	lib/fees/records.ts
Terms / payment allocation	lib/tuition/terms.ts
Database model	database/full-schema-v1.sql

Philippine policy references

1. Supreme Court E-Library. Republic Act No. 11984, No Permit, No Exam Prohibition Act. https://elibrary.judiciary.gov.ph/thebookshelf/showdocs/2/97059

2. Department of Education. DO No. 016, s. 2020, Senior High School Voucher Program guidelines. https://www.deped.gov.ph/wp-content/uploads/2020/06/DO_s2020_016.pdf

3. DepEd Caraga Regional Memorandum No. 0312, s. 2026, tuition and other school fee approval process. https://caraga.deped.gov.ph/wp-content/uploads/2026/04/RM-NO.-0312-S.-2026-REITERATION-ON-THE-PROCESS-OF-APPROVAL-OF-TUITION-AND-OTHER-SCHOOL-FEES-FOR-PRIVATE-EDUCATION-INSTITUTIONS.pdf

Questions to validate with the supervisor and finance team

1. Is the product intended only for private K-12 schools, or must public-school fee rules also be supported?
2. Which plans are offered: full, semestral, quarterly, monthly, or down payment plus installments?
3. Which credits must be separate: ESC, SHS voucher, scholarships, sibling, employee, academic, or early-payment discounts?
4. Who approves new fees and increases, and what evidence must be attached?
5. Can assessments be reversed, transferred, or prorated after withdrawal, and who may authorize it?
6. What should parents receive: portal statement, printable SOA, email reminder, receipt, and downloadable history?

This document is a product and operations review, not legal advice. National and regional requirements should be confirmed with the school's compliance adviser before implementation.